

E101

Applied Professional Experience

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A coordinator is preparing the weekly status report. The project is 10% over budget, and the team did well on a customer demo attended by 40 people. The organization rates variance of 5–15% as amber and above 15% as red. What color should the budget line show?

- A. Amber.
- B. Green, because only the schedule line matters this week.
- C. Red, because any overrun is red.
- D. Green, because the demo went well.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

During a warehouse scanner rollout, the coordinator hears that the Wi-Fi vendor might discontinue a model used at two sites next year. The vendor's rep is friendly and responsive. Where should this be recorded?

- A. The change log.
- B. The risk register.
- C. Nowhere; uncertain events never need logging.
- D. The issue log.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of these belongs in the issue log rather than the risk register?

- A. A key tester may take leave next month.
- B. A new regulation could pass next year.
- C. The test server crashed yesterday and testing has stopped.
- D. A department head requests an added feature.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

The coordinator's manager asks her to add three new report fields requested by a department head. The approved scope does not include them. The department head is known for sending long emails. What is the right first step?

- A. Log a change request and analyze the impact on schedule, cost, and risk before approval.
- B. Refuse, because scope can never change.
- C. Add the fields right away.
- D. Ask the department head to keep emails shorter.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A task with a \$40,000 budget is reported as 60% complete, and \$28,000 has been spent. The contractor also invoiced for travel last week. What is the task's earned value?

- A. \$16,000
- B. \$40,000
- C. \$28,000
- D. \$24,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A task has earned value of \$18,000 and is 45% complete. What is its budget?

- A. \$32,727
- B. \$40,000
- C. \$18,000
- D. \$8,100

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

Halfway through, a task estimated at 10 days now looks like it will take 14. The team lead suggests changing the plan so the original estimate reads 14 days. The team lead is the most senior person on the project. What should the coordinator do?

- A. Change the baseline to 14 days.
- B. Keep the baseline at 10 days, show a 14-day forecast, and report the 4-day variance.
- C. Keep 10 days and say nothing until the task finishes.
- D. Do what the team lead says, since he is most senior.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

When may a project baseline legitimately be changed?

- A.** When the sponsor agrees in a hallway conversation.
- B.** Never, under any circumstance.
- C.** When an approved change request alters scope, schedule, or cost.
- D.** Whenever actual results drift from the plan.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A vendor delay will push go-live past the date the sponsor promised the board, and fixing it is beyond the coordinator's authority. The vendor's office is in another state. What should she do?

- A.** Negotiate a new go-live date with the board herself.
- B.** Travel to the vendor's office.
- C.** Escalate promptly to the project manager or sponsor with the impact and options.
- D.** Wait to see whether the vendor catches up.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which situation should a coordinator resolve without escalating?

- A.** A scope dispute between two sponsors.
- B.** All issues should be escalated to be safe.
- C.** A \$50,000 cost overrun beyond tolerance.
- D.** The meeting room for the weekly check-in is double-booked.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

After a status meeting, the notes say "Look into printer driver problem." The meeting was held in the new conference room with a smart TV. What is missing to make this an effective action item?

- A.** Details about the conference room.
- B.** Nothing; everyone always remembers what was discussed.
- C.** A priority color only.
- D.** A named owner and a due date.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

The coordinator realizes last week's status report showed 70% complete instead of the correct 50%. No one has noticed yet. She has a performance review next month. What should she do?

- A.** Correct the report promptly, notify recipients, and explain how she will prevent a repeat.
- B.** Wait until after her review to correct it.
- C.** Blame the report template.
- D.** Fix it quietly in next week's report.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A coordinator is preparing the weekly status report. The project is 10% over budget, and ~~the team did well on a customer demo attended by 40 people.~~ The organization rates variance of 5-15% as amber and above 15% as red. What color should the budget line show?

Target word: budget status color **Decides:** 10% falls in the 5-15% band.

A	Correct	10% is inside the 5-15% amber band.
B	Adjacent category	Each line is rated on its own measure.
C	Absolute language	Red starts above 15%.
D	Camouflage	A good demo does not change the budget variance.

2. Answer B Concept 2

During a warehouse scanner rollout, the coordinator hears that the Wi-Fi vendor might discontinue a model used at two sites next year. ~~The vendor's rep is friendly and responsive.~~ Where should this be recorded?

Target word: which log **Decides:** The event is uncertain and in the future.

A	Adjacent category	Tracks scope or baseline changes, not uncertain events.
B	Correct	A possible future event.
C	Absolute language	Risks are logged precisely because they are uncertain.
D	Confusion set	Issues have already happened.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

Which of these belongs in the issue log rather than the risk register?

Target word: work backward from log to item **Decides:** Issue = already happened.

A	Inverted operation	A future possibility: a risk.
B	Confusion set	Uncertain and future: a risk.
C	Correct	It has already happened and needs action.
D	Adjacent category	Goes to the change log as a change request.

4. Answer A Concept 3

The coordinator's manager asks her to add three new report fields requested by a department head. The approved scope does not include them. ~~The department head is known for sending long emails.~~ What is the right first step?

Target word: first step on an out-of-scope request **Decides:** The fields are outside approved scope.

A	Correct	Change control comes before the work.
B	Absolute language	Scope can change through the process.
C	Dropped element	Skips impact analysis and approval.
D	Camouflage	Email style has nothing to do with scope.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A task with a \$40,000 budget is reported as 60% complete, and \$28,000 has been spent. ~~The contractor also invoiced for travel last week.~~ What is the task's earned value?

Target word: EV **Decides:** $EV = \% \text{ complete} \times \text{budget}$.

A	Inverted operation	Uses the 40% remaining instead of the 60% complete.
B	Wrong stem number	That is the full budget.
C	Adjacent category	That is actual cost.
D	Correct	$0.60 \times \$40,000 = \$24,000$.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A task has earned value of \$18,000 and is 45% complete. What is its budget?

Target word: solve for budget **Decides:** $\text{Budget} = EV / \% \text{ complete}$.

A	Confusion set	Divides by the 55% remaining.
B	Correct	$\$18,000 / 0.45 = \$40,000$.
C	Wrong stem number	That is earned value.
D	Inverted operation	Multiplies instead of dividing.

7. Answer B Concept 5

Halfway through, a task estimated at 10 days now looks like it will take 14. The team lead suggests changing the plan so the original estimate reads 14 days. ~~The team lead is the most senior person on the project.~~ What should the coordinator do?

Target word: handling a new estimate **Decides:** No approved change exists.

A	Confusion set	Overwriting the baseline hides the variance.
B	Correct	The baseline is the yardstick; the forecast shows reality.
C	Dropped element	Drops the forecast and the variance report.
D	Camouflage	Seniority does not override baseline control.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

When may a project baseline legitimately be changed?

Target word: condition for baseline change **Decides:** Only through approved change.

A	Dropped element	Drops the formal approval record.
B	Absolute language	Approved changes do update the baseline.
C	Correct	Formal approval is required.
D	Confusion set	Drift is variance to report, not a reason to re-baseline.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A vendor delay will push go-live past the date the sponsor promised the board, and fixing it is beyond the coordinator's authority. ~~The vendor's office is in another state.~~ What should she do?

Target word: response to an out-of-authority problem **Decides:** Impact exceeds her authority.

A	Adjacent category	Outside her authority.
B	Camouflage	Location is not the problem to solve.
C	Correct	Decision-makers need early notice and choices.
D	Inverted operation	Delays bad news when speed matters.

10. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

Which situation should a coordinator resolve without escalating?

Target word: work backward to what is within authority **Decides:** Small, within authority, no commitment at stake.

A	Adjacent category	A sponsor-level decision.
B	Absolute language	Over-escalation wastes leaders' time and avoids ownership.
C	Inverted operation	Beyond tolerance: must escalate.
D	Correct	Minor and within her control.

11. Answer D Concept 7

After a status meeting, the notes say "Look into printer driver problem." ~~The meeting was held in the new conference room with a smart TV.~~ What is missing to make this an effective action item?

Target word: what the action item lacks **Decides:** No owner or due date.

A	Camouflage	The meeting location is irrelevant.
B	Absolute language	Unassigned items are routinely dropped.
C	Adjacent category	Priority helps, but ownership and timing are what is missing.
D	Correct	Without them no one is accountable.

12. Answer A Concept 8

The coordinator realizes last week's status report showed 70% complete instead of the correct 50%. No one has noticed yet. ~~She has a performance review next month.~~ What should she do?

Target word: handling her own error **Decides:** The report is wrong and others rely on it.

A	Correct	Transparent correction protects decisions and trust.
B	Camouflage	Her review timing does not change the duty to correct now.
C	Adjacent category	Shifting blame is not accountability.
D	Confusion set	Silent correction leaves people relying on bad data.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Status reporting by threshold	Each status line (budget, schedule) is rated against the organization's defined thresholds, using facts.	Letting good news on one line color another line.	A variance percentage and stated color thresholds.
2	Risk register vs. issue log	Uncertain future events go in the risk register; problems that have already occurred go in the issue log.	Logging a possibility as an issue.	"might," "could" vs. "has happened."
3	Change requests	Out-of-scope requests are logged as change requests, analyzed for impact, and approved before work begins.	Doing the work because a manager asked.	A request not in approved scope.
4	Earned value from percent complete	$EV = \text{percent complete} \times \text{budget for the work}$; it is compared with what was spent (AC).	Using the amount spent as earned value.	A budget, a percent complete, and an amount spent.
5	Baseline vs. forecast	The baseline stays fixed unless an approved change alters it; new estimates are shown as a forecast and the variance is reported.	Overwriting the baseline with the new estimate.	A task now expected to take longer than planned.
6	Escalation	Problems beyond your authority or tolerance are escalated promptly with impact and options; problems within your authority are resolved directly.	Waiting on bad news, or escalating everything.	A problem that affects a commitment above your level.
7	Action items	An action item needs a clear task, a named owner, and a due date.	Recording topics without owners or dates.	Meeting notes like "look into..."
8	Professional accountability	Own and correct errors promptly and transparently, and explain how you will prevent them.	Fixing mistakes quietly or delaying disclosure.	An error no one has noticed yet.

Course scope (public description): This applied experience course provides learners with an immersive, cohesive, project-based experience. Learners apply foundational project management knowledge for an on-the-job early-career project. Through hands-on ownership of planning, and execution, learners practice tracking performance, managing change, documenting risks and issues, and reporting project status to stakeholders. The course emphasizes professional accountability, and real-world project workflows.